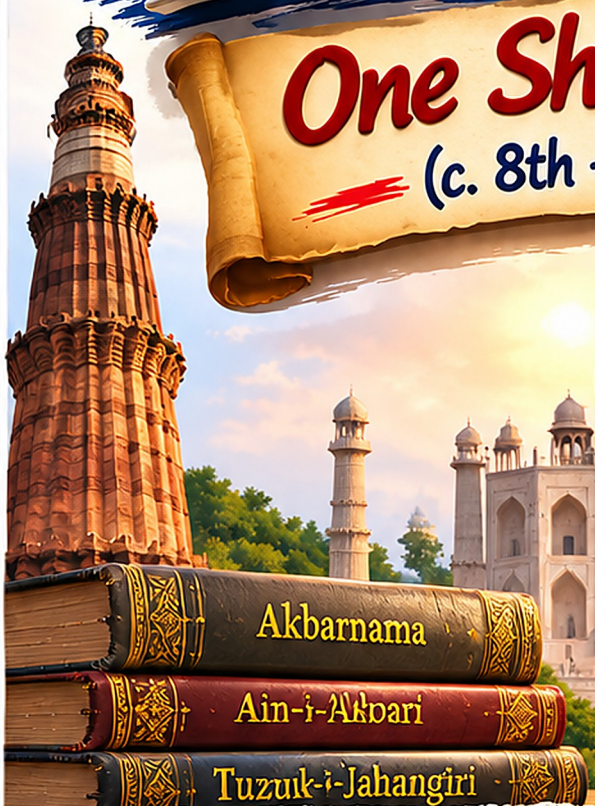
GK Yaad Rahega

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

One Shot Revision

(c. 8th – 18th Century)



UPSC | State PCS | Railway | Bank | SSC | Defence

Early Medieval India & Regional Kingdoms

(8th to 12th Century)

REGIONAL KINGDOMS
(8th – 12th Century)

1. Tripartite Struggle
(For control over Kannauj)

- **Palas** (Bengal)
  - Founder – Gopala
  - Important rulers – Dharmapala, Devapala
  - Promoted Buddhism
  - Major centre – Vikramshila University
- **Gurjara-Pratiharas** (Western India)
  - Important rulers – Nagabhata I, Mihira Bhoja
  - Stopped Arab expansion
  - Controlled Western & Northern India
- **Rashtrakutas** (Deccan)
  - Founder – Dantidurga
  - Important ruler – Amoghavarsha I
  - Controlled Deccan region

2. Cholas (Tamil Nadu)

Brihadeeswara Temple (Thanjavur)

- Founder – Vijayalaya (Chola empire)
- Important rulers – Rajaraja I, Rajendra I
- Rajaraja I – built Brihadeeswara Temple (Thanjavur)
- Rajendra I – overseas campaigns, reached up to Srivijaya (SE Asia)
- Strong navy and maritime trade
- Efficient local administration (Ur, Sabha, Nagaram)
- Important centre – Thanjavur, Gangaikonda Cholapuram

3. Chalukyas (Deccan)

Pattadakal Temple

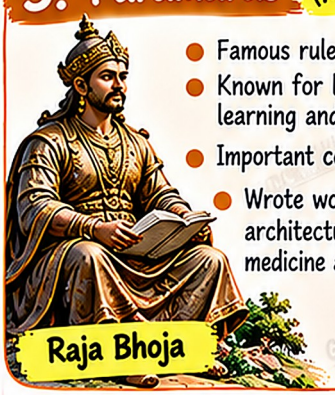
- Important ruler – Pulakeshin II
- Checked Harsha's southward expansion near Narmada
- Important centres – Badami, Aihole, Pattadakal
- Later Chalukyas – Kalyani (Western Chalukyas)

4. Pallavas (Tamil Nadu)

Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram)

- Important rulers – Mahendravarman I, Narasimhavarman I
- Important centre – Kanchipuram
- Famous for rock-cut and structural temples
- Important monuments – Mahabalipuram (Shore Temple)

5. Paramaras (Malwa)


Raja Bhoja

- Famous ruler – Bhoja
- Known for literature, learning and architecture
- Important centre – Dhar
- Wrote works on architecture, grammar, medicine and astronomy

6. Chandelas (Bundelkhand)

Khajuraho Temples

- Important rulers – Yashovarman, Dhanga, Vidyadhara
- Famous for Khajuraho temples
- Important centre – Khajuraho

7. Other Regional Powers

- **Eastern Gangas** (Odisha)
  - Important centre – Kalinga
  - Famous monument – Jagannath Temple tradition, later Konark Sun Temple (13th century)
- **Kalachuris** (Central India)
  - Important centre – Tripuri
- **Hoysalas** (Karnataka)
  - Important centre – Belur, Halebid
  - Famous for temple architecture
- **Yadavas** (Devagiri)
  - Important centre – Devagiri (Daulatabad)

Turkish Invasions & Foundation of Delhi Sultanate

1. Why Turkish Invasions?

- Wealth and resources of India (especially temples).
- Strategic location – gateway to Central Asia.
- Control over trade routes.
- Political disunity among Indian rulers.
- Desire to spread Islam.
- Adventure and personal glory.

2. Mahmud of Ghazni (998–1030)

- Ruler of Ghazni (Afghanistan).
- Made 17 invasions into India (1000–1027).
- Famous invasion – Somnath (1025).
- Captured Punjab.
- Looted many temples – Mathura, Thanesar, Kannauj.
- His aim was plunder of wealth, not to establish a permanent empire.

3. Muhammad Ghori (1173–1206)

- Ruler of Ghor.
- Main aim – establish a permanent empire in India.
- Defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in Second Battle of Tarain (1192).
- Captured Delhi and Ajmer.
- Laid the foundation of Delhi Sultanate.
- Appointed Qutbuddin Aibak as his slave and governor.

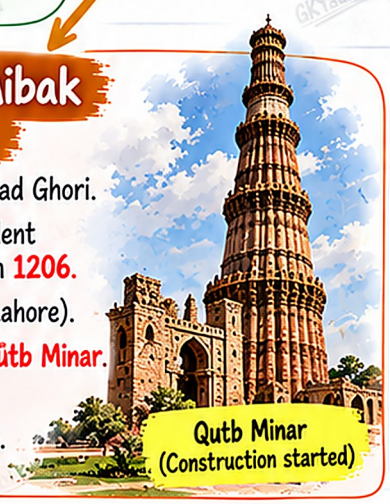
TURKISH INVASIONS (1000–1206)

4. Major Battles

- **First Battle of Tarain (1191)**
  - Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori
  - Result – Prithviraj won.
- **Second Battle of Tarain (1192)**
  - Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori
  - Result – Muhammad Ghori won.
- **Battle of Chandawar (1194)**
  - Jaichand (Gahadavala) vs Muhammad Ghori
  - Result – Ghori won.

5. Qutbuddin Aibak (1206–1210)

- Former slave of Muhammad Ghori.
- Became the first independent ruler of Delhi Sultanate in 1206.
- Capital – Delhi (initially Lahore).
- Started construction of Qūtb Minar.
- Known as Lakh Baksh (gave charity generously).



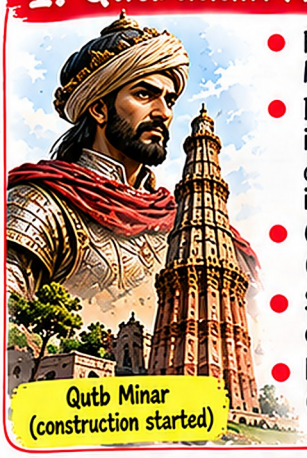
6. Significance

- Marked the beginning of a new political era in Indian history.
- Opened the way for establishment of Delhi Sultanate.
- Brought Turkish military system and administrative practices.
- Led to political, social and cultural changes in India.

Mamluk (Slave) Dynasty (1206–1290)

First Dynasty of Delhi Sultanate

1. Qutbuddin Aibak (1206–1210)



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- Capital – Delhi (initially Lahore).
- Started construction of **Qutb Minar**.
- Known as **Lakh Baksh** (gave charity generously).

2. Iltutmish (1210–1236)

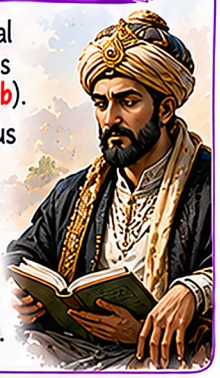
- Consolidated and strengthened the Delhi Sultanate.
- Defeated rivals – Yildiz (in North) and Qubacha (in West).
- Recognised as Sultan by the **Abbasid Caliph** (title of investiture).
- Introduced silver coin – **Tanka** and copper coin – **Jital**.
- Organised administrative system with **Iqta system**.
- Completed construction of **Qutb Minar** and **Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque**.

3. Raziya Sultan (1236–1240)

- Only **woman ruler** of Delhi Sultanate.
- Capable and popular ruler.
- Faced opposition from Turkish nobles (**Chihalgani**).
- Appointed non-Turk nobles, which angered the nobles.
- Was eventually deposed and killed in **1240**.

MAMLUK (SLAVE) DYNASTY (1206–1290)

4. Nasiruddin Mahmud (1246–1266)



- Ruler in name, real power in the hands of **Balban** (as **Naib**).
- Pious and religious ruler.
- Interested in scholarship and religious studies.
- Did not interfere in administration.

5. Balban (1266–1287)

- Strengthened central authority and established a powerful monarchy.
- Introduced the concept of **Zill-i-Ilahi (Shadow of God)** and **Niyabat-i-Khudai** (Deputy of God).
- Controlled the Turkish nobles (**Chihalgani**).
- Strengthened the army and frontier defence against Mongols.
- Maintained strict court discipline and royal etiquette (**Sijda** and **Paibos**).

6. Decline of Mamluk Dynasty

- After Balban, weak rulers came to power.
- Internal conflicts among nobles increased.
- Frequent Mongol threats on north-western frontiers.
- Political instability and rise of powerful nobles.
- End of Mamluk dynasty in **1290** with the accession of **Jalaluddin Khalji** (founded Khalji dynasty).

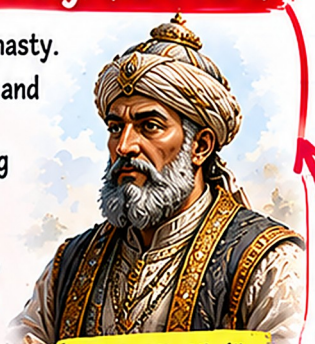
GKYaadRahega

Khalji Dynasty (1290–1320)

Second Dynasty of Delhi Sultanate

1. Jalaluddin Khalji (1290–1296)

- Founder of Khalji dynasty.
- Adopted a moderate and lenient policy.
- Focused on expanding Sultanate in Gujarat and Ranthambore.
- Was assassinated by his nephew Alauddin Khalji in 1296 (at Kara).



Jalaluddin Khalji

2. Alauddin Khalji (1296–1316)

- Most powerful ruler of Khalji dynasty.
- Expanded the empire significantly.
- Defeated Mongols (multiple times).
- Successful campaigns in Gujarat (1299), Ranthambore (1301), Chittor (1303), Malwa (1305) and Deccan (1308–1311).
- Used Malik Kafur for southern campaigns.
- Introduced market and price control measures.
- Implemented military reforms – Dagh (branding) and Chehra (descriptive rolls).
- Maintained a large standing army.

Alauddin Khalji

3. Mongol Invasions

- Repeated invasions during Alauddin's reign.
- Major attacks in 1297, 1299, 1303, 1305 and 1306.
- All were successfully defeated.
- Strengthened the Delhi Sultanate's military system.

Mongol Invasion

KHALJI DYNASTY (1290–1320)

4. Market Reforms

- Controlled prices of essential commodities.
- Established Diwan-i-Riyasat to regulate markets.
- Fixed prices of grains, cloth, horses, slaves and other goods.
- Strict punishment for hoarding and black marketing.
- Helped in maintaining a large army at low cost.

Price Control

5. Military Reforms

- Dagh – branding of horses to prevent fraud.
- Chehra – descriptive rolls of soldiers.
- Maintained large standing army (about 475,000).
- Regular payment in cash.
- Strengthened spy system (Barid and Munhiyan).

Dagh system (horse branding)

6. Malik Kafur & Southern Campaigns

- Trusted general of Alauddin Khalji.
- Led campaigns in Devagiri (1308), Warangal (1309), Dwarasamudra (1310) and Madurai (1311).
- Brought back large wealth and tribute.
- Extended the influence of Delhi Sultanate to South India.

Malik Kafur

7. End of Khalji Dynasty (1316–1320)

- After Alauddin's death, weak rulers succeeded – Shihabuddin, Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah.
- Khalji rule ended with the assassination of Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah in 1320 by Khusrau Khan, who established the short-lived Khusrau Khan dynasty.

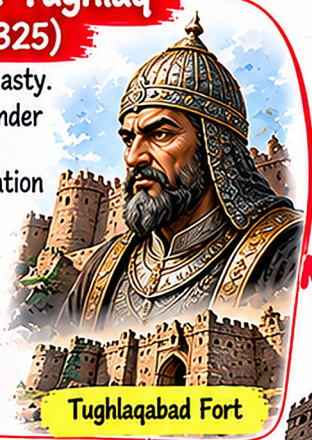
End of Khalji Dynasty

Tughlaq Dynasty (1320–1414)

Third Dynasty of Delhi Sultanate

1. Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (1320–1325)

- Founder of Tughlaq dynasty.
- Previously a governor under Khilji ruler.
- Strengthened administration and military.
- Built Tughlaqabad Fort (Delhi).
- Died due to accidental collapse of a pavilion in 1325.

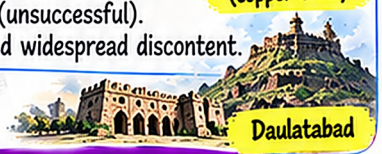


Tughlaqabad Fort

2. Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1325–1351)

- Intelligent but impractical ruler.
- Attempted to make Delhi a world capital.
- Important measures:
  - Transfer of capital – Delhi to Daulatabad (de facto).
  - Introduced token currency (copper coins).
  - Increased tax in Doab region.
  - Planned expedition to Khurasan and Karachil (unsuccessful).
- Faced revolts and widespread discontent.

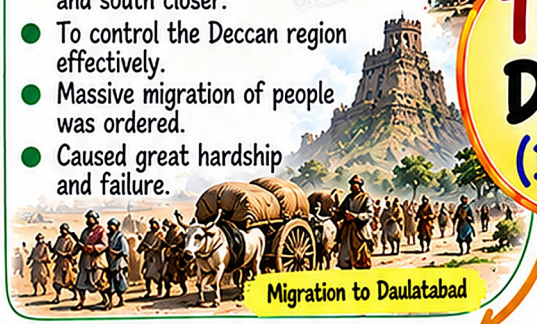
Token Currency (copper coins)



Daulatabad

3. Capital Transfer Delhi → Daulatabad

- Aimed to bring north and south closer.
- To control the Deccan region effectively.
- Massive migration of people was ordered.
- Caused great hardship and failure.



Migration to Daulatabad

TUGHLAQ DYNASTY (1320–1414)

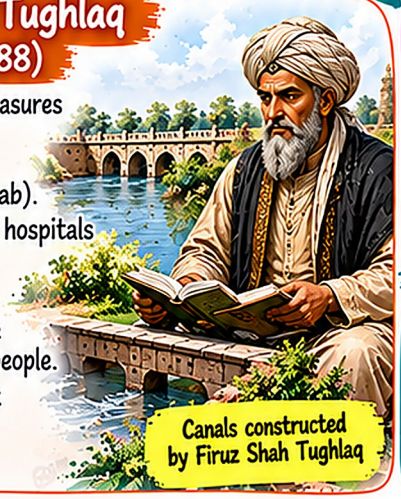
4. Token Currency

- Introduced copper coins as token currency.
- Aim – to overcome shortage of silver.
- People started counterfeiting coins.
- Result – policy failed and withdrawn.

Copper Token Coin (introduced by Muhammad bin Tughlaq)

5. Firuz Shah Tughlaq (1351–1388)

- Focused on welfare measures and public works.
- Constructed canals (Haryana, Punjab, Doab).
- Established madrasas, hospitals and rest houses.
- Reintroduced jizya.
- Encouraged agriculture and settled displaced people.
- Laid down more lenient administration.



Canals constructed by Firuz Shah Tughlaq

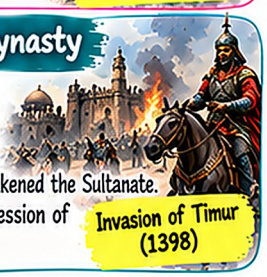
6. Important Constructions

- Tughlaqabad Fort – Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
- Jahanpanah – Muhammad bin Tughlaq (around Delhi)
- Firoz Shah Kotla – Firuz Shah Tughlaq
- Hauz Khas – expanded by Firuz Shah Tughlaq
- Canals – by Firuz Shah Tughlaq
- Reconstruction of Ashokan pillars at Delhi and Firozabad

Firoz Shah Kotla

7. Decline of Tughlaq Dynasty (1388–1414)

- Weak successors after Firuz Shah.
- Rise of provincial kingdoms.
- Invasions of Timur (1398) badly weakened the Sultanate.
- End of dynasty in 1414 with the accession of Sayyid dynasty (Khizr Khan).



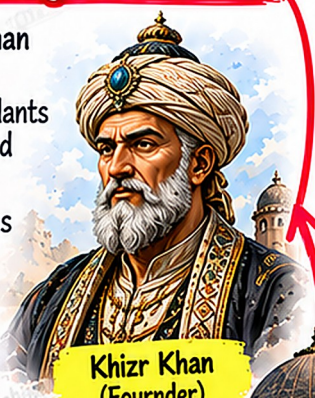
Invasion of Timur (1398)

Sayyid and Lodi Dynasties (1414–1526)

Later Delhi Sultanate

1. Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451)

- Founded by Khizr Khan in 1414.
- Claimed to be descendants of Prophet Muhammad (Sayyids).
- Weaker than previous dynasties.
- Ruled under the suzerainty of Timur and acknowledged his supremacy.



Khizr Khan (Fournder)

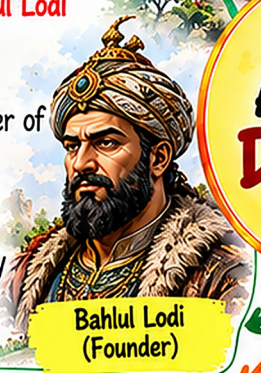
2. Important Rulers

- Khizr Khan (1414–1421)
  - Founder, ruled from Delhi.
- Mubarak Shah (1421–1434)
  - Expanded the kingdom.
  - Attempted to regain lost territories.
- Muhammad Shah (1434–1445)
  - Faced rebellions of nobles.
- Alauddin Alam Shah (1445–1451)
  - Last ruler of Sayyid dynasty.
  - Voluntarily handed over the throne to Bahlul Lodi in 1451.

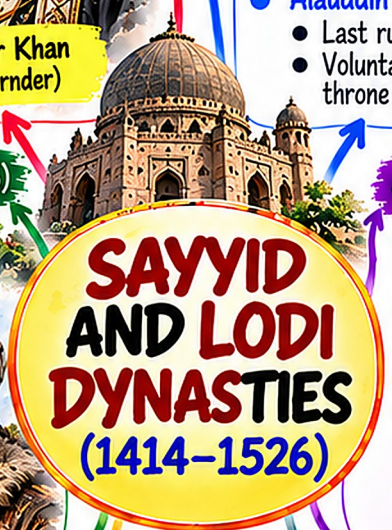
Sayyid Tomb (Delhi)

3. Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526)

- Founded by Bahlul Lodi in 1451.
- Afghan dynasty.
- Revived the power of Delhi Sultanate.
- Followed a more practical and conciliatory policy towards nobles.



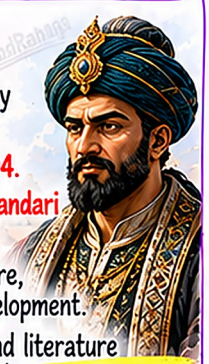
Bahlul Lodi (Founder)



SAYYID AND LODI DYNASTIES (1414–1526)

4. Sikandar Lodi (1489–1517)

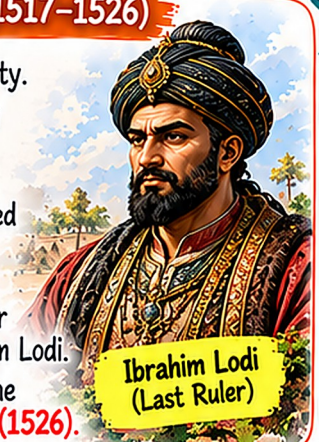
- Most powerful ruler of Lodi dynasty.
- Expanded the territory of the Sultanate.
- Founded Agra in 1504.
- Introduced Gaj-i-Sikandari (standard measure).
- Encouraged agriculture, trade and urban development.
- Patron of learning and literature (Persian and Sanskrit).



Sikandar Lodi

5. Ibrahim Lodi (1517–1526)

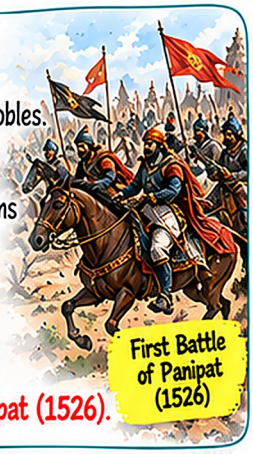
- Last ruler of Lodi dynasty.
- Faced discontent among Afghan nobles.
- Treated nobles harshly and followed a centralised policy.
- Daulat Khan Lodi and Alam Khan invited Babur to India to defeat Ibrahim Lodi.
- Defeated and killed in the First Battle of Panipat (1526).



Ibrahim Lodi (Last Ruler)

6. Causes of Decline

- Frequent conflicts among Afghan nobles.
- Harsh policies of Ibrahim Lodi.
- Growing power of regional kingdoms (Rajputs, Mewar, Malwa, Bengal, Jaunpur).
- Invitation to Babur by Daulat Khan Lodi and Alam Khan.
- Defeat in the First Battle of Panipat (1526).



First Battle of Panipat (1526)

Southern & Deccan Kingdoms

Vijayanagara Empire and Bahmani Kingdom

1. Vijayanagara Empire (1336–1565)

- Founded in 1336 by Harihara and Bukka (brothers).
- Established by Sangama dynasty.
- Capital – Vijayanagara (Hampi) on the banks of Tungabhadra River (Tungabhadra Doab).
- Acted as a strong Hindu empire against the expansion of Delhi Sultanate and the Deccan sultanates.

Harihara and Bukka (Founders)

2. Important Rulers

- Harihara I (1336–1356)
  - Founded the empire.
- Bukka I (1356–1377)
  - Consolidated and expanded the empire.
- Devaraya II (1424–1446)
  - Strengthened the army.
- Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529)
  - Most powerful ruler.
  - Expanded the empire to its greatest extent.
  - Promoted art, literature and architecture.
  - Famous work – Amuktamalyada (Telugu).

Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529)

3. Administration (Amara-nayaka System)

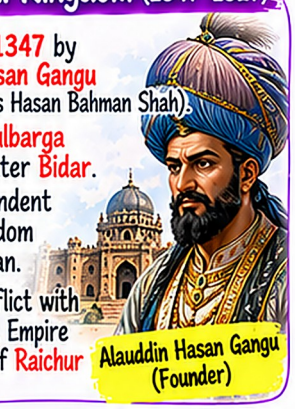
- Empire was divided into provinces called nayankaras.
- These were given to Amara-nayakas (military chiefs).
- They collected revenue and maintained a military force.
- Helped in quick mobilisation of army.
- Kept a check on internal rebellions.

Amara-nayaka System

SOUTHERN & DECCAN KINGDOMS

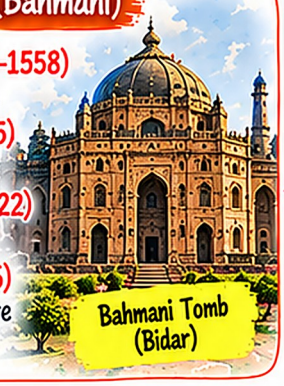
4. Bahmani Kingdom (1347–1527)

- Founded in 1347 by Alauddin Hasan Gangu (also known as Hasan Bahman Shah).
- Capital – Gulbarga (initially), later Bidar.
- First independent Muslim kingdom in the Deccan.
- Often in conflict with Vijayanagara Empire for control of Raichur Doab.


Alauddin Hasan Gangu (Founder)

5. Important Rulers (Bahmani)

- Alauddin Hasan Gangu (1347–1558)
  - Founder of Bahmani kingdom.
- Muhammad Shah I (1358–1375)
  - Expanded the territory.
- Firoz Shah Bahmani (1397–1422)
  - Shifted capital to Bidar.
- Ahmad Shah Wali (1422–1436)
  - Promoted art, Persian culture and architecture.


Bahmani Tomb (Bidar)

6. Battle of Talikota (1565)

- Combined forces of Deccan sultanates (Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar and Berar) defeated Vijayanagara Empire.
- Led to the decline of Vijayanagara Empire.

Battle of Talikota (1565)

7. Decline of Both Kingdoms

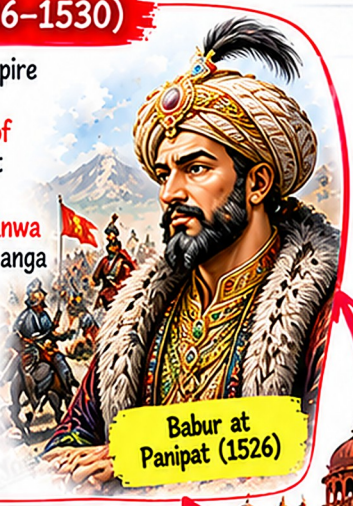
- Vijayanagara declined after the Battle of Talikota (1565).
- Later ruled by Aravidu dynasty, but lost power.
- Bahmani kingdom broke into five independent sultanates – Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmadnagar, Bidar and Berar.

Early Mughals (1526–1556)

Babur and Humayun

1. Babur (1526–1530)

- Founder of Mughal Empire in India.
- Won the First Battle of Panipat (1526) against Ibrahim Lodi.
- Won the Battle of Khanwa (1527) against Rana Sanga of Mewar.
- Used gunpowder, field artillery and Tulughma tactics.
- Wrote Baburnama (Tuzuk-i-Baburi) (in Chagatai Turkish).


Babur at Panipat (1526)

2. Military Tactics of Babur

- Used gunpowder and canon (artillery) effectively.
- Used Tulughma tactic (dividing army into wings to attack from sides and rear).
- Used Araba (wagon-line defence) to protect artillery.
- Combined mounted archers with firearms.
- Disciplined and well-trained army.

Mughal Artillery and Tulughma Tactic

3. Important Battles of Babur

- First Battle of Panipat (1526) – Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi (Mughal victory).
- Battle of Khanwa (1527) – Babur vs Rana Sanga of Mewar (Mughal victory).
- Battle of Chanderi (1528) – Babur vs Medini Rai (Mughal victory).

Battle of Khanwa (1527)

EARLY MUGHALS (1526–1556)

4. Humayun (1530–1540, (1555–1556)

- Son of Babur.
- Faced challenges from Afghans, especially Sher Shah Suri.
- Defeated in the Battle of Chausa (1539) and Battle of Kannauj (1540).
- Went into exile (1540–1555).
- Recaptured Delhi with the help of Persian ruler Shah Tahmasp in 1555.
- Died in 1556 after falling from the stairs of his ilbrary in Delhi.

Humayun (1530–1556)

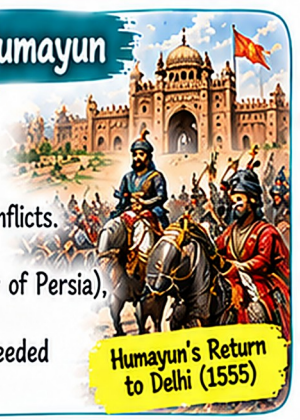
5. Sher Shah Suri (Interlude: (1540–1555)

- Defeated Humayun in Chausa (1539) and Kannauj (1540).
- Ruled 1540–1545.
- Excellent administrator.
- Introduced important reforms in revenue, coinage and roads (Grand Trunk Road).
- Died in 1545 in Kalinjar Fort.

Sher Shah Suri (1540–1545)

6. Restoration of Humayun (1555–1556)

- After Sher Shah Suri and his successors, Sur dynasty weakened due to internal conflicts.
- Humayun, with the help of Shah Tahmasp (Safavid ruler of Persia), regained Delhi in 1555.
- Died in 1556, and was succeeded by his son Akbar.


Humayun's Return to Delhi (1555)

Sher Shah Suri (1540–1545)

Administration & Reforms

1. Rise to Power

- Originally Farid Khan (Suri).
- Served under the Lodi dynasty.
- Defeated Humayun in the Battle of Chausa (1539).
- Consolidated power after the Battle of Kannauj (1540).
- Ruler of the Sur Empire (1540–1545).

2. Land Revenue System

- Measured land with Gaj-i-Sikandari (standard measuring rod).
- Classification of land based on fertility.
- Assessment of revenue on the basis of average produce (1/3rd of produce).
- Introduced Patta (written deed given to cultivators).
- Introduced Qabuliyat (agreement to pay revenue).

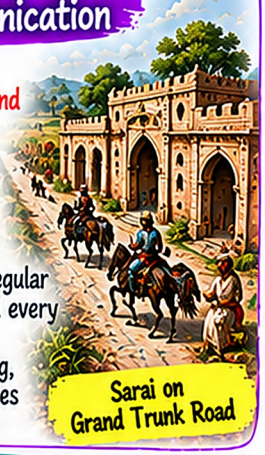
3. Currency Reforms

- Introduced silver coin Rupiya.
- Weight – 178 grains (approx. 11.5 grams).
- Standardised coinage system of gold, silver and copper.
- Rupiya continued for several centuries in India (even during Mughal period).

ADMINISTRATION & REFORMS OF SHER SHAH SURI

4. Roads, Sarais & Communication

- Constructed and improved the Grand Trunk Road (Shershah Road) from Sonargaon (Bengal) to Indus (Peshawar).
- Built sarais at regular distances (around every 10–12 kos).
- Facilities – lodging, food, water, stables and security.

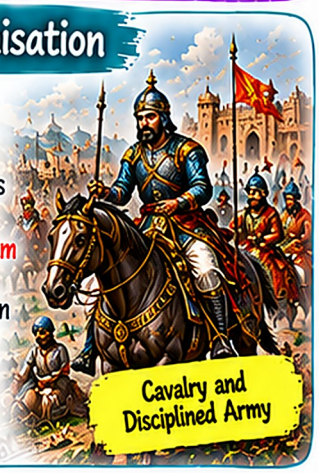


5. Administrative Measures

- Divided the empire into Sarkars (provinces), Parganas and Villages.
- Appointed competent officials and maintained strict supervision.
- Introduced efficient system of espionage (intelligence network).
- Ensured justice and quick disposal of cases.

6. Military Organisation

- Maintained a strong standing army.
- Divided the army into cavalry, infantry, elephants and artillery.
- Introduced the Dagh system (branding of horses).
- Chehra system (description of soldiers) to prevent fraud.
- Well-organised and disciplined army.

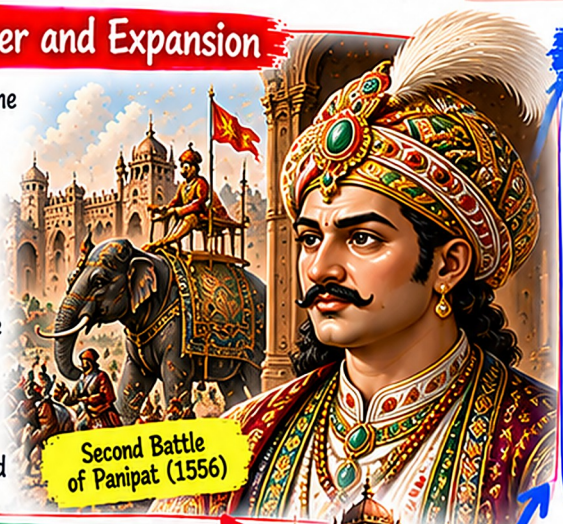


Akbar's Empire (1556–1605)

Administration, Policies and Achievements

1. Rise to Power and Expansion

- Acceded to the throne in 1556 (after the death of Humayun).
- Consolidated power after defeating Hemu in the Second Battle of Panipat (1556).
- Expanded the empire through military conquests (Malwa, Gujarat, Bengal, Rajasthan, etc.).
- By 1605, established a vast empire.



2. Mansabdari System

- Introduced Mansabdari system for civil and military administration.
- Each mansabdar had two ranks – Zat (personal rank) and Sawar (cavalry rank).
- Ranks ranged from 10 to 10,000.
- Ensured a loyal and efficient administrative and military structure.

3. Revenue Administration

- Revenue reforms by Raja Todar Mal.
- Introduced Zabt system (standardised revenue assessment).
- Based on measurement of land (using the gaj-i-sikandari).
- Classified land into fertile, medium and barren categories.
- Fixed average produce of last 10 years to determine revenue.

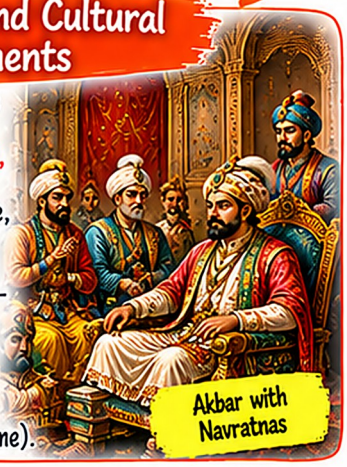
AKBAR'S EMPIRE (1556–1605)

4. Rajput and Religious Policies

- Followed a policy of alliance with Rajputs through marriage and diplomacy.
- Appointed Rajputs to high administrative posts (e.g., Man Singh).
- Followed Sulh-i-kul (universal tolerance).
- Abolished Jizya (1564).
- Practised a policy of religious tolerance and inclusion.

5. Navratnas and Cultural Achievements

- Nine courtiers known as Navratnas (e.g., Birbal, Tansen, Abul Fazl, Faizi, Raja Todar Mal).
- Promoted art, literature, music and architecture.
- Translation of Sanskrit granths (Mahabharata – Razmnama).
- Development of Mughal painting style.
- Built Fatehpur Sikri (his capital for some time).



6. Important Battles and Conquests

- Second Battle of Panipat (1556) – defeated Hemu.
- Conquest of Malwa (1561).
- Conquest of Gujarat (1572).
- Defeat of Rana Pratap (Battle of Haldighati, 1576).
- Annexation of Bengal (1576).
- Conquest of Kabul (1581).
- Expanded empire to large parts of North and Central India.

Later Great Mughals (1605–1707)

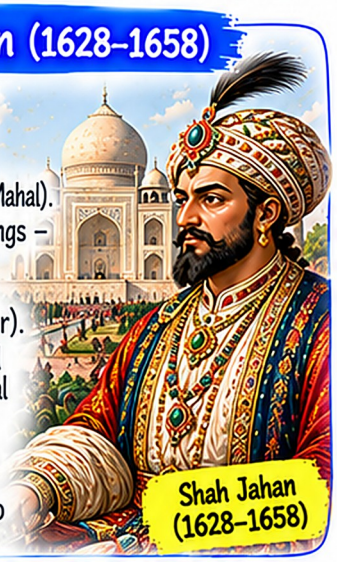
Jahangir → Shah Jahan → Aurangzeb

1. Jahangir (1605–1627)

- Succeeded Akbar.
- Known for love of art, painting and nature.
- Important painter – Ustad Mansur (natural history paintings).
- Strengthened the tradition of justice (e.g., Chain of Justice).
- Important work – Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri (autobiography).
- Faced revolts by Prince Khusrau.

2. Shah Jahan (1628–1658)

- Known for splendid Mughal architecture.
- Built Taj Mahal (in memory of Mumtaz Mahal).
- Other important buildings – Red Fort (Delhi), Jama Masjid (Delhi), Shalimar Bagh (Kashmir).
- His reign is considered a golden age of Mughal art, architecture and culture.
- Faced increasing financial strain due to lavish expenditure.



3. Aurangzeb (1658–1707)

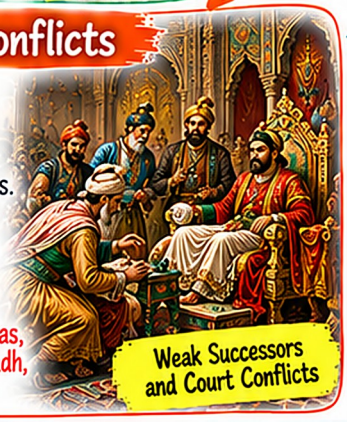
- Acceded to the throne after a war of succession (1658).
- Followed an orthodox Sunni policy.
- Reimposed Jizya (1679).
- Expanded the empire to its greatest extent (Deccan, South India).
- Long Deccan campaigns against the Marathas (Shivaji and successors).
- His long wars drained the state's resources.

4. Expansion under Later Mughals

- Empire reached its largest extent under Aurangzeb.
- Included most of the Indian subcontinent (except far south).
- Continuous military campaigns in the Deccan.
- Overextension led to administrative and financial difficulties.

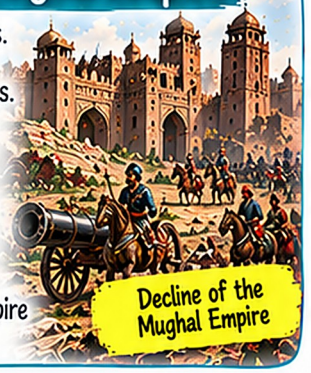
5. Succession Conflicts

- After Aurangzeb, weak successors ruled.
- Frequent wars of succession among princes.
- Nobles and regional governors became more powerful.
- Rise of independent regional powers (Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Rohillas, Awadh, Bengal, Hyderabad).



6. Decline of the Mughal Empire

- Long and costly Deccan wars.
- Weak successors and frequent succession struggles.
- Rise of regional powers.
- Economic crisis and heavy taxation.
- Growing European influence (especially the British).
- Loss of central authority and disintegration of the empire in the 18th century.



Bhakti Movement

(c. 6th – 17th Century)

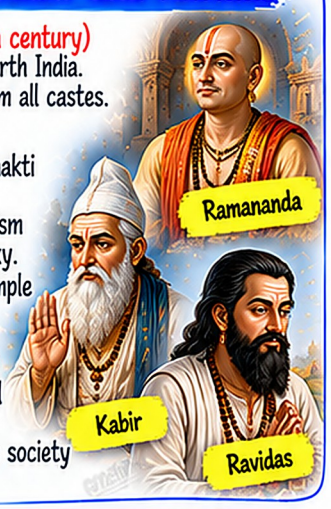
Devotional Traditions in Medieval India

1. Alvars and Nayanars

- Alvars (12 saints) – venerated Lord Vishnu (6th–9th century).
- Nayanars (63 saints) – devotion to Lord Shiva (6th–9th century).
- Composed devotional hymns in Tamil.
- Laid the foundation of the Bhakti movement in South India.
- Promoted personal devotion and simple way of worship.

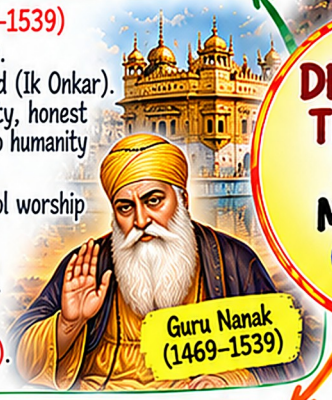
2. Ramananda, Kabir and Ravidas

- Ramananda (14th–15th century)
  - Promoted Bhakti in North India.
  - Accepted disciples from all castes.
- Kabir (15th century)
  - Believed in Nirguna Bhakti (formless God).
  - Opposed caste, ritualism and religious orthodoxy.
  - Composed dohas in simple Hindavi language.
- Ravidas (15th century)
  - Preached equality and social harmony.
  - Believed in a casteless society ('Begumpura').



3. Guru Nanak and Sikh Tradition

- Guru Nanak (1469–1539)
  - Founder of Sikhism.
  - Believed in one God (Ik Onkar).
  - Emphasised equality, honest work and service to humanity (Seva).
- Rejected caste, idol worship and ritualism.
- Composed hymns in Gurmukhi and other regional languages (Guru Granth Sahib).



DEVOTIONAL TRADITIONS (BHAKTI MOVEMENT)

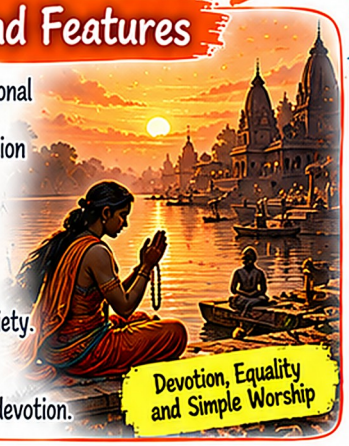
(c. 6th – 17th Century)

4. Mirabai and Chaitanya

- Mirabai (16th century)
  - Devotion to Lord Krishna.
  - Composed bhajans in Rajasthani/Braj Bhasha.
  - Defied social norms and royal life for devotion.
- Chaitanya Mahaprabhu (15th–16th century)
  - Preached devotion to Krishna through sankirtana (group singing).
  - Promoted Gaudiya Vaishnavism in Bengal and Odisha.

5. Teachings and Features

- Emphasised love and personal devotion to God.
- Opposed caste discrimination and social inequality.
- Rejected empty rituals, formalism and priestly intermediaries.
- Stressed on moral values, humility and service to society.
- Accepted both Saguna (with form) and Nirguna (without form) forms of devotion.



6. Languages and Compositions

- Used regional languages for spreading their message (Tamil, Hindi, Braj, Rajasthani, Bengali, Marathi, Punjabi, etc.).
- Compositions included bhajans, kirtans, abhangas, padas, dohas and shabads.
- Made religious teachings accessible to common people.
- Contributed to the development of Indian साहित्य (literature) and cultural unity.

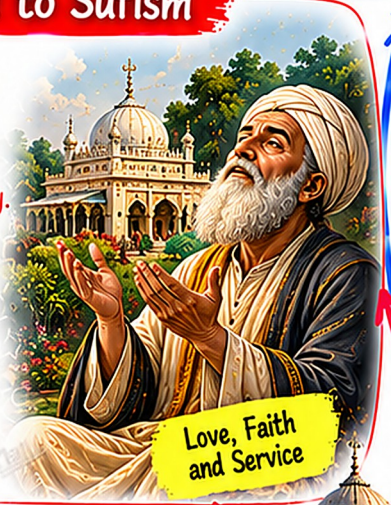
Sufi Traditions

(12th – 17th Century)

Saints, Silsilas and Teachings in Medieval India

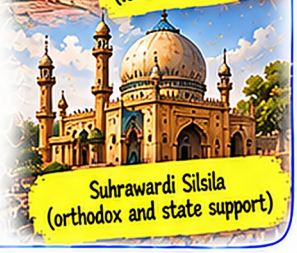
1. Introduction to Sufism

- Mystical and spiritual dimension of Islam.
- Emphasis on love, humility, tolerance and service to humanity.
- Popular among all sections of society irrespective of caste and religion.
- Helped in the cultural and social integration of Indian society.



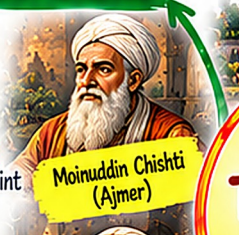
2. Major Silsilas (Orders)

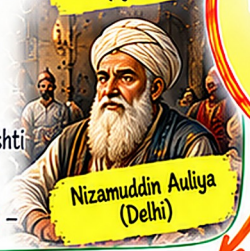
- **Chishti Silsila**
  - Most popular in India.
  - Emphasis on love, tolerance and service to people.
  - Adopted Indian cultural practices.
- **Suhrawardi Silsila**
  - More orthodox and close to the state.
  - Emphasis on Sharia and discipline.
- **Others**
  - Qadiri and Naqshbandi silsilas also had influence in later period.



3. Prominent Sufi Saints

- Moinuddin Chishti (d. 1236) – introduced Chishti Silsila in India (Ajmer).
- Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki (d. 1235) – early Chishti saint (Delhi).
- Baba Farid (d. 1265) – important Chishti saint (Punjab).
- Nizamuddin Auliya (d. 1325) – greatest Chishti saint, known for love and compassion (Delhi).
- Shah Madar, Gesu Daraz – important later saints.

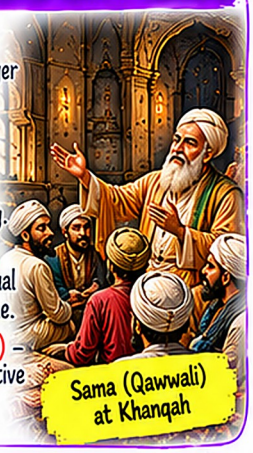




SUFI TRADITIONS (12th – 17th Century)

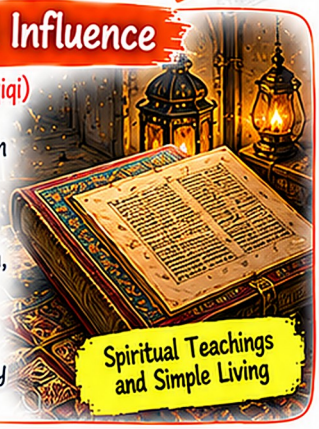
4. Khanqah, Sama and Practices

- Khanqah – centre for spiritual learning, prayer and social service.
- Sama – listening to music and devotional songs (qawwali) to attain spiritual ecstasy.
- Guidance (Pir-Murid relationship) – spiritual initiation and discipline.
- Langar (free kitchen) – food for all, irrespective of caste or religion.



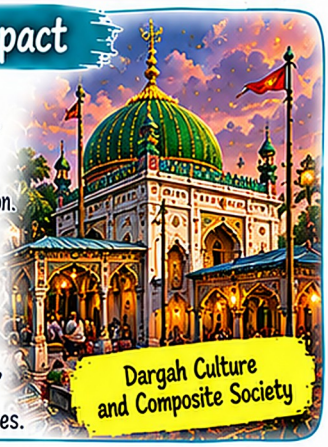
5. Teachings and Influence

- Emphasised love (Ishq-e-Haqiqi) and devotion to God.
- Rejected caste discrimination and religious orthodoxy.
- Stressed simplicity, humility and selfless service.
- Used local languages (Persian, Hindavi, Punjabi, etc.).
- Their ideas influenced Bhakti movement and promoted communal harmony in India.



6. Legacy and Impact

- Spread of Sufism across North India, Punjab, Bengal, Deccan and South India.
- Khanqahs became centres of social and cultural interaction.
- Helped in composite culture (Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb).
- Influenced art, music (qawwali), literature and architecture (dargahs).
- Many dargahs (Ajmer, Delhi, Punjab, Gulbarga) became important pilgrimage centres.



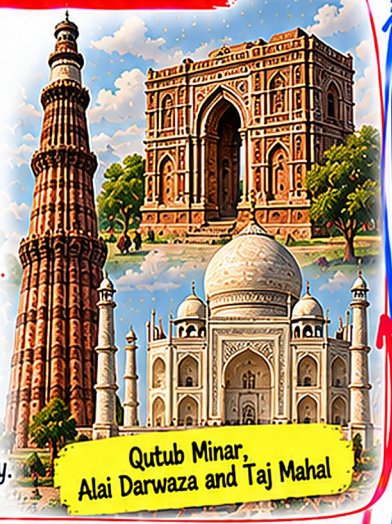
Art, Architecture, Literature & Culture

(c. 8th – 18th Century)

Cultural Achievements in Medieval India

1. Indo-Islamic Architecture

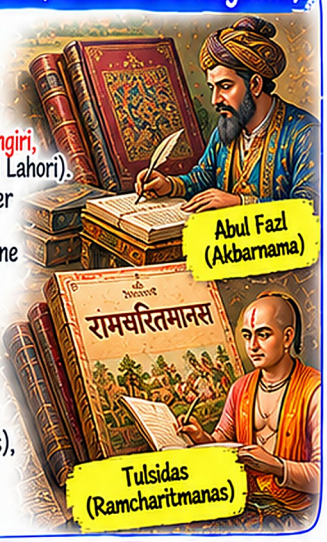
- Synthesis of Indian and Islamic styles.
- Use of arches, domes, minarets and large courtyards.
- Important structures – Qutub Minar (Delhi), Alai Darwaza, Tughlaq architecture, Lodi tombs.
- Mughal architecture – Humayun's Tomb, Fatehpur Sikri, Red Fort, Jama Masjid, Taj Mahal.
- Use of materials like red sandstone, marble and decorative calligraphy.



Qutub Minar, Alai Darwaza and Taj Mahal

2. Literature (Persian, Sanskrit & Regional)

- Persian – language of administration and court.
- Important works – Akbarnama (Abul Fazl), Ain-i-Akbari, Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri, Padshahnama (Abdul Hamid Lahori).
- Sanskrit – continued under Hindu rulers; works on history, astronomy, medicine and philosophy.
- Regional languages – Bhakti and Sufi literature in Hindi, Tamil, Bengali, Punjabi, Marathi, etc.
- Popular compositions – Ramcharitmanas (Tulsidas), Padavali (Chaitanya), Gurubani (Guru Nanak), Abhangas (Tukaram).



Abul Fazl (Akbarnama)

Tulsidas (Ramcharitmanas)

3. Historians, Travellers and Books

- Important historians – Al-Biruni (Kitab-ul-Hind), Ziauddin Barani, Ibn Battuta (Rihla), Abul Fazl (Akbarnama), Badauni (Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh).
- Travel accounts – Al-Biruni (India), Ibn Battuta (Delhi Sultanate), Bernier (Mughals), Tavernier (trade & economy), Manucci (court life).
- Provide valuable information on society, economy, administration, religion and culture.

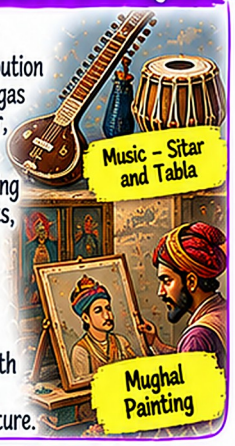
Al-Biruni (Kitab-ul-Hind)

Ibn Battuta (Rihla)

CULTURAL ACHIEVEMENTS IN MEDIEVAL INDIA (c. 8th – 18th Century)

4. Music, Painting and Performing Arts

- Music – development of Hindustani music; contribution of Amir Khusrau (new ragas and instruments like sitar, tabla – popularization).
- Painting – Mughal painting school (realism, portraits, miniature style).
- Important centres – Akbar, Jahangir and Shah Jahan's reigns.
- Performing arts – growth of dance, drama, folk traditions and court culture.



Music – Sitar and Tabla

Mughal Painting

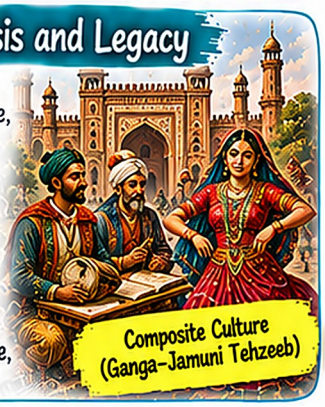
5. Technological and Scientific Developments

- Advances in architecture and engineering (domes, arches, water supply systems).
- Development of gardens – charbagh style.
- Improvement in irrigation and agricultural techniques.
- Use of paper, better coinage system and improved metallurgy (weapons).
- Contributions in astronomy, medicine and mathematics continued and expanded.

Charbagh Garden (Mughal innovation)

6. Cultural Synthesis and Legacy

- Blend of Indian and Islamic traditions in art, architecture, language, dress and food.
- Growth of composite culture (Ganga-Jamuni tehzeeb).
- Influence visible in festivals, music, literature and social practices.
- Left a lasting impact on Indian culture, visible even today in monuments, language, cuisine and traditions.



Composite Culture (Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb)

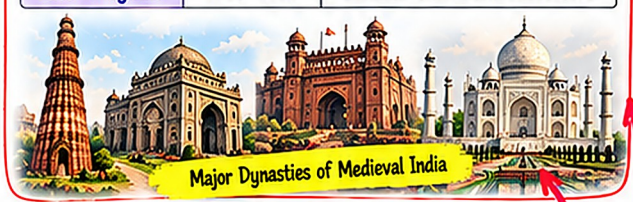
Master Timeline & Rapid Recall

(8th – 18th Century)

Medieval History at a Glance

1. Dynasties in Chronological Order

Dynasty	Period	Important Rulers
Arab Rule (Sindh)	712–750	Muhammad bin Qasim
Ghaznavids	977–1186	Mahmud of Ghazni
Ghurids	1175–1206	Muhammad Ghori
Delhi Sultanate	1206–1526	Mamluk, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi
Sur Dynasty	1540–1556	Sher Shah Suri
Mughal Empire	1556–1707	Akbar, Jahangir, Shah Jahan, Aurangzeb
Later Mughals	1707–1857	Bahadur Shah I and successors



Major Dynasties of Medieval India

2. Important Battles and Key Dates

Battle	Year	Between	Significance
Battle of Tarain (I)	1191	Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori	Victory of Prithviraj
Battle of Tarain (II)	1192	Prithviraj Chauhan vs Muhammad Ghori	Start of Turkish rule in India
Battle of Chandawar	1194	Jaichand vs Muhammad Ghori	Defeat of Jaichand
Battle of Khanwa	1527	Babur vs Rana Sanga	Establishment of Mughal power
Battle of Chausa	1539	Humayun vs Sher Shah	Defeat of Humayun
Battle of Kannauj	1540	Humayun vs Sher Shah	End of Mughal rule (temporary)
Second Battle of Panipat	1556	Akbar vs Hemu	Akbar's accession
Battle of Haldighati	1576	Akbar vs Maharana Pratap	Mughal victory (Pratap escaped)
Battle of Buxar	1764	British vs Shuja-ud-Daula, Mir Qasim, Shah Alam II	Beginning of British dominance

Major Battles Shaping Medieval India

3. Ruler – Reform – Monument Quick Recall

Ruler	Key Reforms / Policies	Important Monument
Iltutmish	Iqta system, strengthened Sultanate	Qutub Minar (completed)
Alauddin Khilji	Market reforms, army reforms	Alai Darwaza
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	Administrative experiments	Jahanpanah, Daulatabad (proposed)
Firoz Shah Tughlaq	Public works, irrigation	Firoz Shah Kotla
Sher Shah Suri	Land revenue, roads, sarais, Rupiya	Purana Qila, GT Road (sarais)
Akbar	Mansabdari, Zabt, Rajput policy	Fatehpur Sikri
Jahangir	Art, painting, justice	Shalimar Bagh (Kashmir)
Shah Jahan	Architecture	Taj Mahal, Red Fort (Delhi)
Aurangzeb	Deccan campaigns, Jizya (restored)	Bibi Ka Maqbara (Aurangabad)

Important Rulers and Their Contributions

MEDIEVAL HISTORY AT A GLANCE (8th – 18th Century)

4. Travellers, Books, Titles and Terms

Traveller / Historian	Period	Famous Work / Contribution
Al-Biruni	11th century	Kitab-ul-Hind (on Indian society)
Ibn Battuta	14th century	Rihla (travel account)
Abdul Hamid Lahori	17th century	Padshahnama (Akbar)
Badauni	16th century	Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh
Bernier	17th century	Accounts of Mughal administration
Manucci	17th century	Travels in India (Mughal court life)

Important Titles

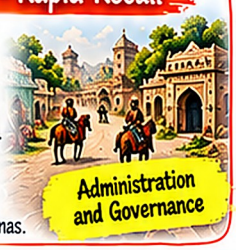
- Sultan – ruler of Delhi Sultanate
- Padshah – Mughal emperor
- Nawab – provincial ruler
- Khan, Malik, Amir – high officials
- Mansabdar – Mughal officer

Important Terms

- Iqta – land grant (Sultanate)
- Mansabdari – Mughal military-civil rank
- Zabt – revenue system (Akbar)
- Jagir – land assignment
- Khanqah – Sufi centre
- Sarais – rest houses
- Silsila – Sufi order

5. Administration and Policies – Rapid Recall

- Iqta system – land revenue system (Sultanate).
- Mansabdari – rank system (Mughal).
- Zabt – standardised revenue (Akbar).
- Dagh and Chehra – army reforms (Sher Shah).
- Market reforms – price control (Alauddin Khilji).
- Religious policies – Sulh-i-kul (Akbar), Jizya (Aurangzeb).
- Roads and sarais – Sher Shah.
- Provincial administration – subas, sarkars, parganas.



Administration and Governance

6. Culture, Religion and Society – Quick Points

- Bhakti Movement – Ramananda, Kabir, Ravidas, Mirabai, Chaitanya.
- Sufi Saints – Moinuddin Chishti, Nizamuddin Auliya.
- Architecture – Qutub Minar, Alai Darwaza, Taj Mahal, Red Fort.
- Literature – Persian (Abul Fazl), Sanskrit, regional languages (Tulsidas).
- Paintings – Mughal miniature painting.
- Music – development of Hindustani music.
- Composite culture – Indo-Islamic traditions.

Composite Culture of Medieval India